

Tyler Zenisek

Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Software engineer (B.S. Computer Science, cum laude, 2024) who builds and runs production systems end to end: creator of Balisong Flipping Center, a live full-stack platform (Spring Boot, React, PostgreSQL) on Terraform-managed AWS, and Latch, its Claude-powered AI assistant with tool calling and an evaluation harness.

PROJECTS

Balisong Flipping Center · Creator & Sole Developer

Mar 2024 – Present · [Live App](#) · [GitHub](#)

- Built and run a live community platform (posts, collections, catalog, messaging) on Spring Boot, React, and PostgreSQL.
- Implemented JWT auth with refresh tokens, Google OAuth2, email verification, admin step-up login, and enforced bans.
- Built real-time notifications and messaging over WebSocket/STOMP with JWT-authenticated connections.
- Provisioned AWS in Terraform (CloudFront, S3, EC2, ECR, SSM); test-gated GitHub Actions deploys via OIDC.
- Cut monthly AWS spend about 60% (\$105 to \$40) by auditing Cost Explorer usage and removing redundant environments.

Latch: AI Assistant · Creator

Aug 2026 – Present · [GitHub](#)

- Built a FastAPI service running Claude on AWS Bedrock that answers users via tool calls against the platform's live REST API.
- Built an eval harness (29 scenarios, deterministic checks + LLM grader) that drove fixes raising the pass rate from 62% to 92%.
- Streamed responses token by token to the browser; bounded cost with Redis history trimming and prompt caching.
- Gated deploys on a 63-test pytest suite; secured with per-client credentials, session rate limits, and an internal secret.

QuizMaster (Senior Capstone) · Team Lead

Jan 2024 – May 2024 · [Live App](#)

- Led a scrum team building a React/Firebase quiz app; owned 23+ user stories and delivered on schedule.
- Set up CI/CD and fixed 13 database bugs through unit and integration testing.

EXPERIENCE

Contract Lead Android Developer · Galileo Innovations

Chicago, IL · Jan 2020 – Aug 2020

- Led Android development end to end as the primary engineer across a 4-developer, 3-team cross-functional environment.
- Resolved critical WebSocket/Bluetooth data sync bugs that were blocking the team — restored ~2x development velocity.
- Delivered a production-ready prototype in 6 months — application selected and deployed by the U.S. military.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL

Frameworks: Spring Boot, Spring Security, FastAPI, React, Redux, REST APIs, WebSocket/STOMP, JWT/OAuth2

Data: PostgreSQL, Flyway, Redis, MySQL

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2, S3, CloudFront, ECR, Route 53, SSM, Bedrock), Terraform, Docker, GitHub Actions, Linux

Testing & AI: JUnit, Mockito, Testcontainers, pytest, LLM tool calling, prompt caching, LLM evaluation

Certification: AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (in progress)

EDUCATION

B.S. in Computer Science · Lewis University · Romeoville, IL · Graduated 2024

[Graduated Cum Laude](#) · [GPA: 3.5](#)

Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, OOP, Relational Databases, Operating Systems, Software Engineering, Networks

A.S. in Software Development · College of DuPage · Glen Ellyn, IL · Graduated 2022